Regulation-Style Scoresheet

A friendly getting-started guide

Your scoresheet is the paper trail of the game: what was played, when it was played, and the final result. Tournaments require one, clubs use one, and honestly it is the single best learning tool at the board — the game you can replay is a game you can improve.

How to use it

1. **Fill in the top before move one.** Event, date, round, board, both players′ names and ratings. It takes thirty seconds and saves a lot of arguing later.
2. **Write after your opponent replies.** Recording the move pair (yours and theirs) keeps the sheet in step with the position, and you will never be writing while your clock runs low.
3. **Use short piece letters:** K, Q, R, B, N, and nothing for pawns. Captures get an x, checks a +, checkmate a #. Files are letters a–h from your own left-hand side.
4. **Tidy mistakes, do not scratch them out.** One clean line through a wrong entry, then the correction. Heavy scribble clouds look like time cheating to an arbiter.
5. **At the end:** both players circle the result and sign. That signed sheet is the official record used for rating, tiebreaks, and disputes.

Pencils only. Pen ink smears, cannot be corrected cleanly, and has a real talent for jumping onto the board or the clock. Bring a spare pencil — points have a habit of snapping mid-game.

Club tip: A regulation game gives you about one minute per move to write. Writing fast is a skill you can practice at home: replay a short online game and copy the moves down by hand.

Scoresheet

Event: _____ Round: _____ Board: _____

Date: _____ Section: _____ Time control: _____

White: _____ Black: _____

#	WHITE	BLACK
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
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30		

#	WHITE	BLACK
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59		
60		

Result: ☐ 1–0 ☐ 0–1 ☐ ½–½ ☐ Other: _____

Signatures: _____ (White, then Black) _____ Arbiter initials: _____

Pencils only — no pens near the board. Game past move 60? Start a second sheet and write "see sheet 2" in the last cell.